Leadership Styles and Their Impact on Strategic Human Resource Management in Organisations

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Chapter 1: Introduction

1.1 Background of the Study

In the modern organisations, leadership is necessary towards the stratification of the strategic human resource management (SHRM) orientation. With the evolving dynamics and competition in the business enterprise, the alignment of leadership behaviors to strategic HR practices has emerged as a determinant towards the sustainable growth and the involvement of the workforce (Thymi et al., 2022). The horizons of leadership theories and their shifts beyond the classical autocratic models towards more collaborative, transformational, and servant leadership roles are naturally associated with the general understanding that a healthy leadership approach can dramatically impact the organisational culture, staff motivation, and HR results in the long-term perspective.

Strategic HRM, in its turn, is concerned with the alignment of organisational human resource functions, succession planning, performance management, talent acquisition, and learning and development with the organisational vision as a whole. With the alignment of leadership and HR strategies, organisations are in a better position to improve productivity, embrace change, and promote innovation (Costa et al., 2023). Nevertheless, in different industries and organisational environments, serious variations exist to the extent that leadership styles can affect the SHRM in a work reality condition. Early survey feedback, collected via more than 100 professionals representing various sectors such as IT, hospitality, education, and manufacturing, displays that transformational and servant leadership have been viewed as beneficial to the HR functions, yet leadership communication inconsistencies and lack of alignment between strategies impede the success of SHRM in some situations (Wuryania et al., 2021). The proposed study will address these dynamics in planned, quantitative research.

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Chapter	Title	Brief Description
1	Introduction	Introduces the topic, outlines the aim, objectives, research questions, rationale, and significance. Justifies the mixed-methods approach.
2	Literature Review	Reviews leadership theories and SHRM models. Identifies research gaps and develops a conceptual foundation for the study.
3	Research Methodology	Describes the mixed-methods design, sampling, data collection tools, ethical considerations, and analysis plan (SPSS + thematic analysis).
4	Data Analysis and Findings	Presents and analyses quantitative data using **SPSS** and qualitative data through thematic coding. Integrates both findings.
5	Discussion and Conclusion	Interprets results, answers research questions, offers recommendations, and highlights study limitations and future research areas.

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Leadership Style	Key Characteristics	HRM Application	Strengths	Limitations
Transformational	Visionary, Motivational, Developmental	Talent Development, Strategic Alignment	High employee engagement	May overlook day-to-day tasks
Transactional	Task-focused, Reward/Punishment	Compliance, SOP adherence	Efficient in routine environments	Lacks innovation
Servant	People-first, Supportive, Ethical	Employee Welfare, Retention	Builds trust and loyalty	Can be time-consuming
Situational	Adaptive, Contextual	Mixed workforce management	Agile and flexible	Requires high leadership competence
Democratic	Participatory, Inclusive	Employee Involvement	Enhances satisfaction & creativity	Slow decision-making
Autocratic	Directive, Centralized	Crisis Management	Fast in emergencies	Low morale, disengagement
Laissez-Faire	Hands-off, Autonomous teams	Creative Teams	High innovation (when skilled)	Poor accountability and tracking

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Framework/Model	Key Focus Area	HRM Application	Leadership Role
Best Fit Model	Alignment with business context	Customized HR strategy	Adjust strategy to fit market/internal needs
Best Practice Model	Universal HR best practices	Benchmarking and policy standardization	Adopt proven HR techniques
Resource-Based View (RBV)	Internal capabilities	Talent acquisition & retention	Invest in learning and culture
Ulrich's HRBP Model	Strategic positioning of HR	Role clarity across HR functions	Enable HR participation in strategic decisions

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SHRM Area	Leadership Contribution	Most Effective Style	Strategic Outcome
Talent Management	Inspire, mentor, retain high-potential staff	Transformational, Servant	Talent pipelines, retention
Performance Management	Set goals, give feedback, evaluate performance	Transactional, Transformational	Productivity, alignment with KPIs
Workforce Planning	Forecast skills, succession, scalability	Visionary, Situational	Long-term readiness, flexibility
Organizational Culture	Model behaviors, communicate values	Ethical, Participative	Trust, engagement, innovation

Leadership Style	Alignment with SHRM Principles	Compatibility Level	Notes
Transformational	Strong on engagement & innovation	High	Ideal for agile HR systems
Transactional	Focuses on performance control	Moderate	Good for compliance-driven HR
Servant	Empowers employee development	High	Best for retention and culture-building
Autocratic	Top-down, limited employee input	Low	Risk of disengagement
Situational	Adapts to context and needs	High	Supports dynamic workforce planning

Research Approach	Key Features	Strengths	Limitations	Examples from Literature
Quantitative	Numerical, large-sample surveys	Generalizable, replicable	Misses contextual depth	Banmairuroy et al., 2022
Qualitative	Interviews, open-ended responses	Context-rich, interpretive	Limited generalizability	Henderikx and Stoffers, 2022
Mixed-Methods	Combines both	Comprehensive insights	Complex to design and analyze	Thanh and Quang, 2022

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Tool/Mechanism	Function in SHRM	Strategic Outcome	Leadership Benefit
Competency Frameworks	Align leadership traits with HR strategy	Talent mapping, internal promotions	Builds future-ready leaders
Training & Development	Strengthens managerial & HR knowledge	Better employee engagement, retention	Enhances influence & adaptability
HR Analytics (ROI Tracking)	Measures development impact	Evidence-based investment in leadership	Tracks growth & validates programs

Identified Gap	Description	Source/Reference
Lack of Integrated Studies	Leadership and SHRM often studied separately	Mahdi and Nassar, 2021
Limited Mixed-Methods Use	Most studies use single-method research	Specchia et al., 2021
Contextual Narrowness	Region- or industry-specific research dominates	AlNuaimi et al., 2021
Missing Practitioner Insight	Few studies involve real-world HR leaders	Wuryania et al., 2021

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Reliability Statistics

Cronbach's Alpha	N of Items
.965	24

Descriptive Statistics

	N	Minimum	Maximum	Mean	Std. Deviation
Transformational Leadership	103	1	5	3.56	1.152
Transactional Leadership	103	1	5	3.45	1.135
Servant Leadership	103	1	5	3.22	1.163
Situational Leadership	103	1	5	3.48	1.056
Strategic Thinking	103	1	5	3.54	1.074
Cultural Fit of Leadership	103	1	5	3.39	1.148
Ethical Leadership	103	1	5	3.62	1.040
Emotional Intelligence	103	1	5	3.42	1.080
Leadership Influences HR Strategy	103	1	5	3.44	1.026
Leadership Shapes HR Decisions	103	1	5	3.39	1.113
HR Viewed as Strategic Partner	103	1	5	3.25	1.126
Leadership Aligns with Long-Term HR	103	1	5	3.35	1.169
Leadership Communication Supports HR	103	1	5	3.36	1.128
HRM in Leadership Development	103	1	5	3.37	1.102
Leadership Impacts Engagement	103	1	5	3.81	1.020
Leadership Impacts Retention	103	1	5	3.39	1.157

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Correlations

		Transformational Leadership	Transactional Leadership	Servant Leadership	Situational Leadership	Strategic Thinking	Cultural Fit of Leadership	Ethical Leadership
Transformational Leadership	Pearson Correlation	1	.481**	.652**	.576**	.773**	.626**	.646**
	Sig. (2-tailed)		<.001	<.001	<.001	<.001	<.001	<.001
	N	103	103	103	103	103	103	103
Transactional Leadership	Pearson Correlation	.481**	1	.488**	.369**	.386**	.452**	.327**
	Sig. (2-tailed)	<.001		<.001	<.001	<.001	<.001	<.001
	N	103	103	103	103	103	103	103
Servant Leadership	Pearson Correlation	.652**	.488**	1	.472**	.562**	.456**	.436**
	Sig. (2-tailed)	<.001	<.001		<.001	<.001	<.001	<.001
	N	103	103	103	103	103	103	103
Situational Leadership	Pearson Correlation	.576**	.369**	.472**	1	.531**	.582**	.603**
	Sig. (2-tailed)	<.001	<.001	<.001		<.001	<.001	<.001
	N	103	103	103	103	103	103	103
Strategic Thinking	Pearson Correlation	.773**	.386**	.562**	.531**	1	.670**	.617**
	Sig. (2-tailed)	<.001	<.001	<.001	<.001		<.001	<.001
	N	103	103	103	103	103	103	103
Cultural Fit of Leadership	Pearson Correlation	.626**	.452**	.456**	.582**	.670**	1	.543**
	Sig. (2-tailed)	<.001	<.001	<.001	<.001	<.001		<.001
	N	103	103	103	103	103	103	103

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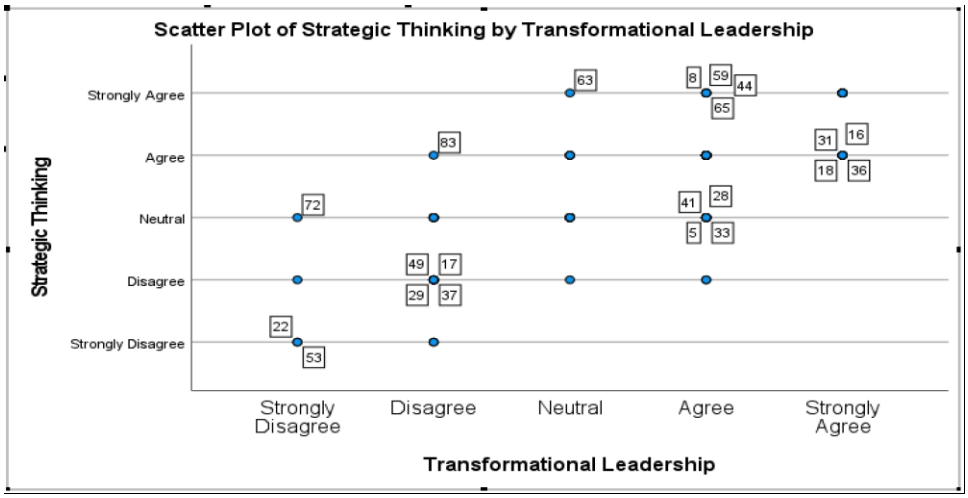

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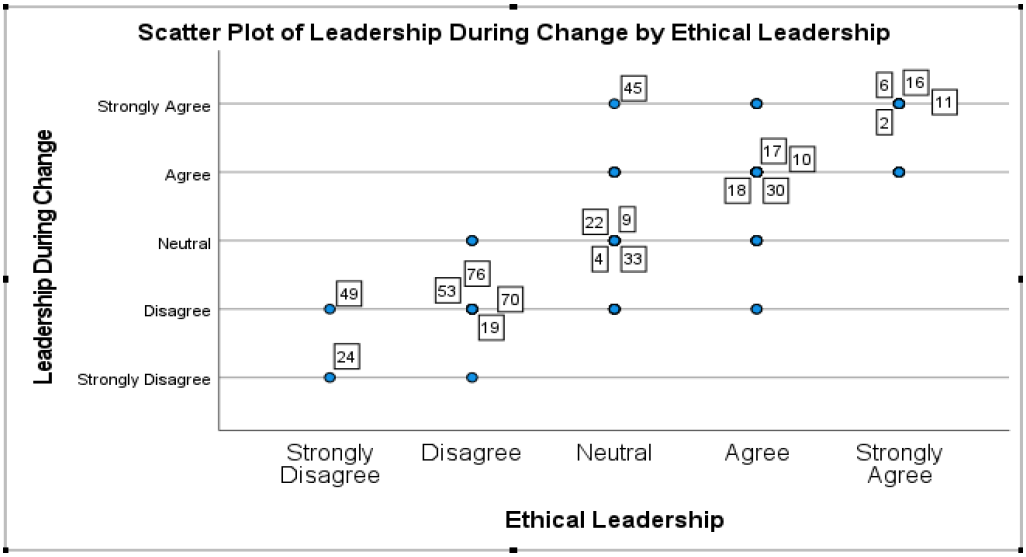

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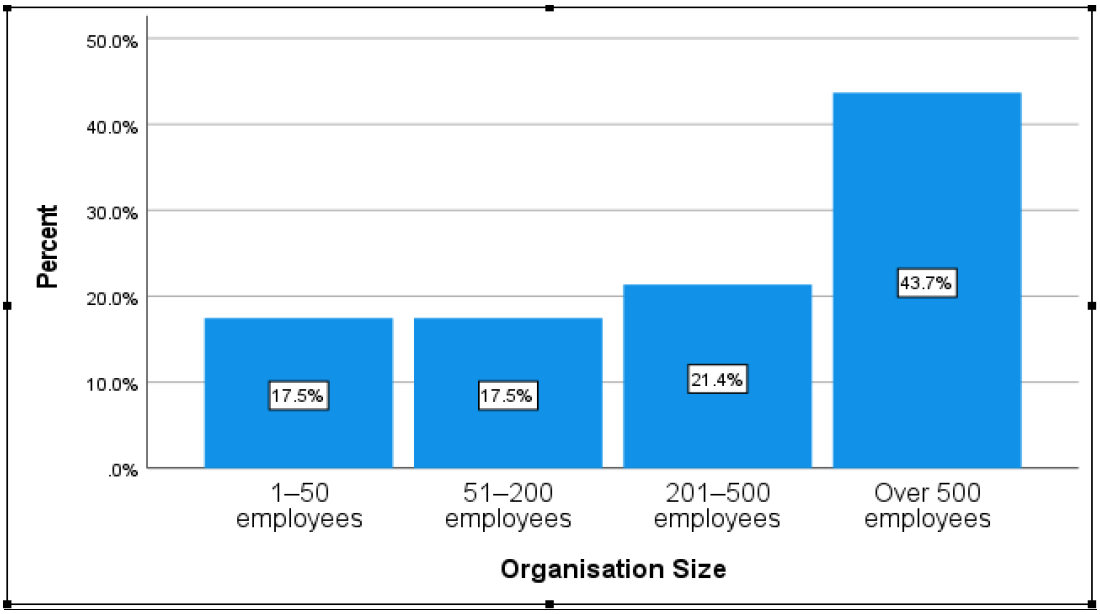
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Percent
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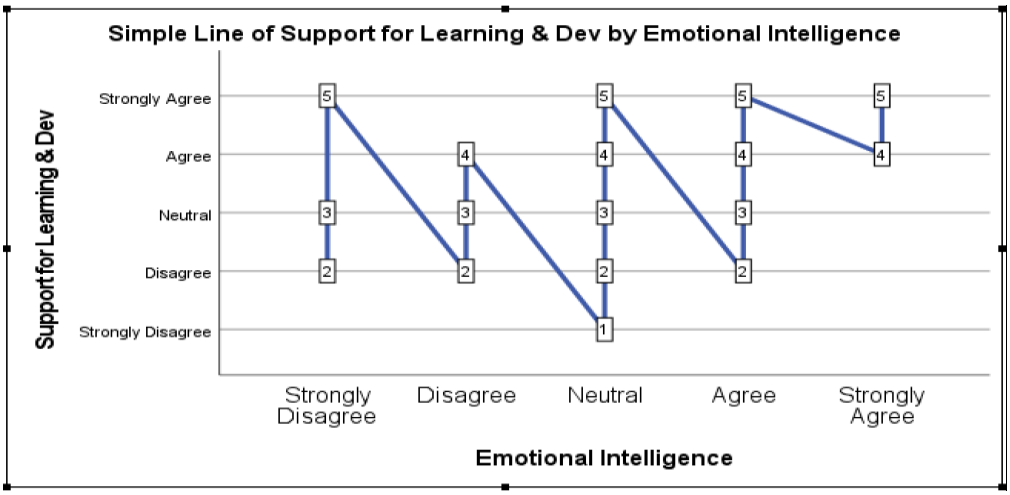
1–50 employees
51–200 employees
201–500 employees
Over 500 employees
Organisation Size



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Model Summary

Model	R	R Square	Adjusted R Square	Std. Error of the Estimate
1	.483[a]	.233	.194	.844

a. Predictors: (Constant), Servant Leadership, Ethical Leadership, Transactional Leadership, Strategic Thinking, Transformational Leadership

ANOVA[a]

Model		Sum of Squares	df	Mean Square	F	Sig.
1	Regression	21.046	5	4.209	5.905	<.001[b]
	Residual	69.148	97	.713		
	Total	90.194	102			

a. Dependent Variable: Leadership Key for SHRM

b. Predictors: (Constant), Servant Leadership, Ethical Leadership, Transactional Leadership, Strategic Thinking, Transformational Leadership

Coefficients[a]

Model		Unstandardized Coefficients B	Unstandardized Coefficients Std. Error	Standardized Coefficients Beta	t	Sig.	Collinearity Statistics Tolerance	Collinearity Statistics VIF
1	(Constant)	2.242	.358		6.256	<.001		
	Transformational Leadership	-.087	.134	-.107	-.648	.519	.291	3.434
	Transactional Leadership	.094	.087	.113	1.079	.283	.715	1.398
	Strategic Thinking	.405	.127	.462	3.179	.002	.374	2.674
	Ethical Leadership	-.042	.109	-.046	-.386	.700	.548	1.826
	Servant Leadership	.092	.099	.114	.930	.355	.528	1.895

a. Dependent Variable: Leadership Key for SHRM

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Collinearity Diagnostics[a]

Model	Dimension	Eigenvalue	Condition Index	Variance Proportions					
				(Constant)	Transformational Leadership	Transactional Leadership	Strategic Thinking	Ethical Leadership	Servant Leadership
1	1	5.776	1.000	.00	.00	.00	.00	.00	.00
	2	.070	9.111	.01	.03	.62	.06	.08	.01
	3	.065	9.449	.31	.02	.00	.00	.06	.45
	4	.042	11.778	.44	.07	.34	.04	.02	.42
	5	.029	14.031	.14	.03	.01	.31	.79	.07
	6	.018	17.722	.10	.86	.03	.58	.05	.05

a. Dependent Variable: Leadership Key for SHRM

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